watch market to a watch culture," says Ulrich Herzog, Chairman, Oris.

Based in Holstein where it was founded in 1904, Oris continues to be an independent watchmaker. "Over the past five years, we have doubled our business in India. It is our fastest growing market," says Herzog.

THE RETAIL REVOLUTION

Ethos reported consolidated revenue from operations of ₹1,612.2 crore in FY26, a 28.8% YoY increase. Luxury and high-luxury watches account for approximately 71% of sales; the average selling price per watch increased 6.1% to ₹2.26 lakh. Ethos operates 103 boutiques in 34 cities.

An important part of this expansion is taking luxury-watch retail beyond its traditional metropolitan strongholds to cities such as Guwahati, Lucknow, Dehradun, Mangalore, Srinagar, Patna, and Agra. Saboo says the response has been encouraging. The demand in these cities is not restricted to relatively affordable watches. The company often gets buyers willing to spend up to ₹30 lakh on a timepiece. "If a buyer asks for a watch that we do not have in that store, we fly it in from our other store along with a few more options," says Saboo.

He believes the watch-buying experience remains integral to the product. Ethos therefore encourages customers to research watches online but complete the purchase in-store.



"If a buyer asks for a watch that we do not have in that store, we fly it in from our other store along with a few more options"

YASHOVARDHAN SABOO
FOUNDER & CHAIRMAN, ETHOS

LUXURY GOES DIGITAL

Yet physical retail is only one part of the story. Online platforms are increasingly demonstrating that consumers are willing to make substantial purchases without visiting a boutique. "Luxury watches is one of the strongest-performing categories on Tata CLiQ Luxury and continues to be a key scale-driver," says CEO Gopal Asthana. Luxury watch sales have recorded a compound annual growth rate of more than 35% over five years.

The platform has focused on overcoming the trust deficit traditionally associated with buying expensive products online. Authorised brand partnerships, authenticity assurance, detailed product information, and assisted sales services enable customers to consult specialists before and after the purchase. Its launch of TimeVallée's first digital boutique in India reflects the growing importance of online luxury retail.

Tata CLiQ Luxury has also entered the pre-owned watch category through The Pre-Owned Timeless Icons, offering timepieces from brands including Rolex, Omega, and Breitling.

In February 2026, it hosted a digital auction of 75 pre-owned watches; 75% of the collection was sold, with the highest bid reaching ₹64 lakh. Notably, the highest-value watch was purchased by a person from Nagpur, and not from a metro city.

Tata CLiQ Luxury reports strong watch demand from Coimbatore, Nagpur, Lucknow, Surat, Jaipur, and Guwahati. People from smaller locations, including Godhra, Bareilly, and Katni, also purchase online.

For brands, digital retail offers access to affluent customers in markets where opening an exclusive boutique may not yet make commercial sense.

Montblanc's experience reinforces the point.

Walia says the company serves customers in approximately 325 Indian cities through its wider product business and has reached more than 800 cities since 2018, when it went live on Tata CLiQ Luxury. Its first order came from Kanpur Dehat, although that purchase was a wallet rather than a watch.

The future, Asthana believes, will be increasingly omnichannel.

AN INDIAN IDENTITY EMERGES

As international watchmakers expand their pres-